THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 9 ENGLISH — READING SKILL PAPER SET 03

Reading Comprehension | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 45 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 20**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A has one passage with 12 questions (1 mark each).
3. Section B has one case-based passage with 8 questions (1 mark each).
4. Questions include MCQs and short answers of 30–40 words.
5. Write the question number before each answer.
6. Answers must be written in the answer book in the order of the questions.

SECTION — A (Reading Comprehension: Factual / Discursive Passage, 400–450 words) 12 Marks

Read the passage and answer the questions.

1. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 12

Failure is a word that most students dread, yet nearly every successful person has a story that begins with one. A scientist repeats an experiment many times before it works. A cricketer is dropped from a team before returning as a captain. A writer receives rejection letters before one book is published. What separates these people from others is not an absence of failure but the choice to continue.

The trouble is that schools and families often measure a child by marks alone. A low score becomes a label, and a child who is labelled soon begins to believe it. Fear of failure then makes her avoid new subjects, new games and even new questions. She does only what is safe, and safe things rarely lead to growth.

The most useful thing about failure is that it is specific. A poor mark in mathematics does not say that a student is unintelligent; it points to a particular chapter that was not understood. When a cricketer is bowled out, the coach replays the shot and finds the exact movement of the feet that went wrong. Failure, seen this way, is not a verdict but a map, showing precisely where the road must be repaired.

It also teaches humility and patience, qualities no textbook can hand over. Those who have never failed often give up at the first difficulty, because they have no memory of climbing back. Those who have failed and recovered carry a quiet confidence: they know that a bad day is only a day. Schools can help by praising effort and by letting students correct their mistakes instead of hiding them.

History offers many examples. Scientists whose experiments failed a hundred times have changed the world on the hundred and first. Writers whose manuscripts were rejected by publisher after publisher later found readers in millions. What they shared was not unusual talent but unusual stubbornness: each treated rejection as information, adjusted the method and tried again. Students need not dream of such fame to benefit from the example. The next time a test goes badly, the sensible question is not 'Why am I so poor?' but 'What exactly did I miss, and how shall I learn it?'

A better approach is to treat a mistake as information. When a student studies a wrong answer, she discovers a gap that can be filled. Teachers can help by praising effort and improvement, not just results. Parents can help by asking, 'What did you learn?' rather than 'Why did you fail?' When the fear of failure shrinks, curiosity grows.

(i) According to the passage, what separates successful people from others? 1

(a) The choice to continue after failure **(b)** Luck

(c) Wealth **(d)** Absence of failure

(ii) The word 'dread' in the first line means: 1

(a) fear **(b)** praise **(c)** enjoy **(d)** ignore

(iii) A child who is labelled by marks: 1

(a) becomes proud **(b)** forgets it

(c) begins to believe the label **(d)** ignores it

(iv) Which example is given of a failure before success? 1

(a) A farmer losing land **(b)** A cricketer dropped from a team

(c) A singer losing a voice **(d)** A doctor leaving work

(v) The writer suggests that parents should ask: 1

(a) 'What did you learn?' **(b)** 'Who is first?'

(c) 'How many marks?' **(d)** 'Why did you fail?'

(vi) Why do children avoid new things when they fear failure? 1

(vii) How can a student use a wrong answer? 1

(viii) What should teachers praise according to the writer? 1

(ix) Find a word in the passage that means 'to reject or turn away from'. 1

(x) What grows when the fear of failure shrinks? 1

(xi) The writer compares failure to a: 1

(a) closed door **(b)** heavy bag

(c) map showing where the road must be repaired **(d)** bright lamp

(xii) What do people who have failed and recovered gain? 1

SECTION — B (Reading Comprehension: Case-based Passage, 200–250 words) — 8 Marks

Read the text and answer the questions.

2. *Read the following case and answer the questions that follow.* 8

A group of Class 9 students conducted a small survey on what they eat during the long break. Seventy students were asked to name the item they bought most often from the canteen. The results are shown below.

Item	Number of students
Samosa	24
Sandwich	14
Fruit	8
Biscuits	16
Sprouts chaat	8

The students presented the findings to the school nurse, who observed that nearly one-third of the children chose a fried snack. She explained that fried food is high in oil and salt, and that eating it daily may lead to tiredness and weight gain in the long run. She suggested that the canteen contractor should offer at least two healthy items, such as fruit and sprouts, at lower prices than the fried ones.

The Principal agreed and asked the survey team to repeat the exercise after two months. If the sale of healthy items has increased, the school will invite a nutritionist to talk to the students and parents. A poster competition on 'Eat Right, Stay Bright' will also be organised in the third week of the month.

The survey team also noted that very few students had said they brought food from home, and they plan to ask the class teachers to encourage students to carry a fruit or a homemade snack at least twice a week.

(i) How many students took part in the survey? 1

(a) 80 **(b)** 24 **(c)** 60 **(d)** 70

(ii) Which item was bought by the most students? 1

(a) Sandwich **(b)** Biscuits **(c)** Fruit **(d)** Samosa

(iii) The nurse said fried food is high in: 1

(a) water **(b)** fibre **(c)** oil and salt **(d)** vitamins

(iv) The poster competition will be on: 1

(a) 'Fit India' **(b)** 'Eat Right, Stay Bright'

(c) 'Save Water' **(d)** 'Healthy Week'

(v) How many students chose fruit or sprouts chaat altogether? 1

(vi) What may daily fried food lead to, according to the nurse? 1

(vii) What did the nurse suggest to the canteen contractor? 1

(viii) When will the survey be repeated? 1

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 20 Marks**

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